

Capstone

Congratulations on making it to the Capstone! We're excited to see what you build, so let's hop right into it.

Teams

Teams are self-selected. You can find a group that you want to work with. If you don't have a team, come to the pitch meeting where you can discuss project ideas and find a team there.

Team sizes must be 2-4 people.

Mentorship

Each team will be paired with a mentor for the Capstone. You'll meet with them a couple of times over the course of the project through scheduled stand-ups, where you'll talk through where your project stands, what's working, and what's not. Your mentor is there to help you think through problems.

Project Tracks

Your team decides whether to focus on building a product or building a technical challenge.

Track 1: Product

Build a deployed AI product that adds real value to the people who use it — not a thin wrapper or generic generator, but something that actually solves a problem in a way that's not trivial to copy.

The goal is validation. You need to get your product in front of real potential users and have them actually try it. Their feedback should tell you whether the product is genuinely useful.

You should also be able to describe what makes your product hard to reproduce. What do you offer the customer that a competitor couldn't easily throw together in a weekend. That being said, this isn't a moat-and-strategy exercise; keep it simple and grounded in the product itself.

Track 2: Technical Challenge

This track is for the researchers, those who want to go deep on a single idea rather than build a customer-facing product. Pick a problem that dives into a hard technical challenge.

Success here looks like real technical depth. Select a hard problem and produce results that further your own (and hopefully others') understanding of what's possible with the technology. This is a chance to explore, not just to ship.

Presenting at Demo Day

Demo Day will be an all day event at Gauntlet HQ with presentations happening in the atrium. We will cater breakfast, lunch, and dinner. Every team will be assigned a time slot and give a **10-minute presentation with 5 minutes of Q&A**.

Product Track Presentations

Your presentation should include:

- The problem you are solving
- Explanation of how you solved the problem
- A product demo
- The feedback you got from users
- A slide deck

Technical Challenge Presentations

Your presentation should include:

- The problem or research question you took on
- Explanation of your approach and how you solved it

- A technical demo or walkthrough of your results
- What you learned and where the work could go next
- A slide deck

At the end, there will be a judging panel and an audience vote that will determine the best projects. The top projects will present the same presentation during the Gauntlet Showcase. Gauntlet Showcase is a live streamed event with presentations from Gauntlet staff, hiring partners, and challengers with thousands watching online.

Building Traction on X

Part of what we do here is build things people actually notice — not just ship, but get traction for it. Every **person** should treat building an audience on X as part of the project, not an afterthought. This applies to **both tracks** — a Technical Challenge project should be able to generate outside interest too, not just internal recognition.

Target per person by Demo Day (Sept 9):

- **150+ total engagements** on your project posts (likes + reposts + replies combined)
- **25+ new followers** gained on your account
- **At least 5 build-in-public posts** — progress updates, demos, results, behind-the-scenes — not just one launch post
- **At least 1 repost or quote-post from someone outside your team** — a real signal someone found it worth sharing

These are floors, not ceilings. Track your numbers and be ready to share them as part of your Demo Day presentation.

Key Dates

- Cursor Workshop: Tuesday, September 8 at Gauntlet HQ
- Demo Day: Wednesday, September 9 at Gauntlet HQ
- Showcase: Thursday, September 10 at Gauntlet HQ
- Graduation: Friday, September 11 at TBD